

Product Analysis Portfolio

Boss Zhipin

From Recruitment Matchmaking to Career Decision Platform

Job Seeker Experience & Product Optimization Analysis

CORE THESIS

A recruitment platform should not only tell users "where the jobs are," but also tell them "how the market responds to me."

Recruitment Matchmaking → Application Management → Market Feedback →
Career Decision

Independent Analysis | Based on Real Job Search Scenarios

01 Project Background

This product observation originates from real-world job search scenarios. As job seekers continuously browse positions, submit resumes, communicate with HR, and attend interviews, their problem gradually shifts from "I can't find positions" to "I don't know where I stand in the market."

Throughout the job search process, users accumulate vast amounts of data on positions, conversations, and application records. Yet this information often remains scattered across job listings and chat windows. What users truly need is to understand: which positions are a better fit, where they are losing candidates, what HR repeatedly focuses on, and how they should adjust their approach next.

This case therefore defines the problem as: How can a recruitment platform evolve from a simple job-matching tool into a comprehensive tool for process management, market feedback, and career decision-making?

Project Objectives

- Reduce the time cost caused by repeated applications and redundant browsing.
- Enable users to clearly manage the current stage of each job application.
- Transform scattered application and communication records into actionable personal job search data.
- Use AI to analyze market feedback, helping users identify issues and refine their job search strategy.

02 User Journey

If you only look at the platform's surface flow, job searching seems straightforward: search for positions → submit resume → communicate → interview. But in actual use, users experience much finer state changes.

Stage	User Behavior	Core Question
Discovery	Searching positions, reviewing job descriptions	Is this role right for me? Have I applied to this company before?
Contact	Initiating outreach, waiting for HR response	Will HR reply to me?
Communication	HR asking questions, sending resume	What do they care about most in my background?
Progress	Exchanging contact info, waiting for feedback	What stage am I actually at right now?
Interview	Attending online/offline interviews	Why did I get this interview? Why didn't it move forward?
Review	Continuing to apply to other positions	What types of roles suit me best? What should I adjust next?

Key Finding

The platform currently excels at solving "information access" and "communication matchmaking." But after users complete application after application, there is a missing "job search feedback layer" that can consolidate these behaviors and help users understand themselves better.

03 Four Core Pain Points

Pain Point 1 — Repeated Applications

Users cannot quickly identify "have I applied to this company before?"

The same company may post identical or similar positions through multiple HR representatives. If a user has already applied — or even been rejected — they still need to manually recall and search through records when encountering similar positions again.

Pain Point 2 — Status Management

Real job search progress is far more complex than platform labels suggest.

The actual process might be: initiate outreach → wait for HR reply → HR replies → exchange resume → wait for resume feedback → exchange phone number → wait for interview → interview → wait for result. Users need more than just "communicated" — they need their own progress markers for every conversation.

Pain Point 3 — Lack of Market Feedback

Users don't know "which positions work better for me."

Users can see their own application and communication records, but struggle to answer systematically: Which industries have higher response rates? Which types of positions are more likely to lead to interviews? What kinds of companies are more receptive to my background?

Pain Point 4 — AI Lacks Personal Data Loop

If AI only polishes resumes, it solves the "expression" problem; but what users truly need is also "judgment." The platform's existing application, position, and communication data can be further transformed into personal market feedback and actionable recommendations.

04 Solution 1: Application & Status Management

Goal: Let users know "how far along I am with this position" without opening every chat window.

A. Add "Applied" Badge to Position Cards

- Mark whether the user has already applied to this company/position.
- If multiple similar positions exist at the same company, ☐☐ "You already have applications at this company."
- Allow users to see historical outcomes, such as "ended" or "not a fit."

B. Add User-Defined Statuses to Chat List

- Waiting for HR response
- Waiting for resume feedback
- Waiting for interview
- Needs follow-up
- Not a good fit
- Ended

Design Principle: System status tells users what happened; user tags tell users what to do next. This transforms a "chat tool" into a "job search task management tool."

05 Solution 2: Personal Job Search Data Hub

Core idea: Convert user behavior scattered across job listings and chat windows into an analyzable job search funnel.

Stage	Core Metric	Question Users Want Answered
Applications	Number of applications	How much effort have I put in?
Responses	HR response rate	Which positions are more likely to reply to me?
Resume	Resume exchange rate	For which positions does my resume pass more easily?
Contact	Phone/WeChat exchange rate	Which conversations move forward?
Interviews	Interview rate	What types of positions give me interviews most often?
Offers	Offer rate	Which directions ultimately suit me best?

Further Breakdown Dimensions

- Position: job title, function, experience requirements, whether career changes / no experience are accepted.
- Industry: SaaS, internet, cross-border e-commerce, consumer goods, software services, AI, etc.
- Company: company size, growth stage, foreign / domestic enterprise, industry type.
- Location: city, workplace, whether overseas travel / posting is involved.
- Position characteristics: domestic vs. overseas clients, whether vertical industry experience is required, etc.

Ultimately, users see not just "how many I've applied to," but rather: "What do I apply to that most often yields positive feedback?"

06 Solution 3: HR Feedback Analysis

Throughout the job search, every question and rejection from HR is potential market feedback. With user consent and privacy protection, the platform can structurally categorize communication information.

Potential Feedback Tags

- Lacks vertical industry experience
- Lacks overseas client / foreign trade experience
- English proficiency needs further confirmation
- Work years / experience don't match
- Questions about employment gaps
- Position direction doesn't match background
- Current position does not accept career changers
- Company not currently hiring this background type

The point is not to make hiring judgments on HR's behalf, but to help job seekers discover: which issues are repeatedly blocking my conversion?

Example

"In recent conversations, HR has repeatedly asked about your overseas client experience. We recommend checking the match quality of related positions and preparing a consistent explanation and interview answer in advance."

07 Solution 4: AI Career Decision Assistant

I believe AI's value should not stop at "helping me write a better resume." It should go further into "helping me decide what to do next."

AI Input Layer

- Personal application records
- Job descriptions and position tags
- HR communication and structured feedback
- Interview / outcome records
- User-defined job search goals

AI Analysis Layer

- Statistical conversion rates by position / industry / company type
- Identify recurring HR questions
- Analyze major drop-off points in the application funnel
- Identify position ranges where users get more positive feedback

AI Output Layer

- Market positioning: For which types of positions does your background match better?
- Strategy recommendations: Which category should you increase applications for next week?
- Problem diagnosis: What is your biggest current obstacle?
- Actionable advice: How should resume, messaging, and position filtering be adjusted?

Example

"Among your last 30 applications, SaaS-related positions have a higher HR response rate than cross-border e-commerce positions. Meanwhile, cross-border e-commerce roles more frequently ask about your foreign trade experience. We recommend increasing the proportion of SaaS applications in the next phase, while keeping cross-border e-commerce as an exploration direction."

08 Solution 5: Efficiency Tools & Fine Filtering

Beyond core data capabilities, the platform can further solve a great deal of repetitive work.

Batch resume sending: After initiating conversations with multiple HR contacts, send the corresponding resume version in bulk after user confirmation.

Saved reply templates: Create response templates for common questions like English proficiency, foreign trade experience, employment gaps, and reasons for career changes.

AI-assisted replies: Identify HR questions and match candidate templates, sent after user confirmation.

Historical position filtering: One-click filtering of already viewed, applied, ended, or rejected positions.

Fine position filtering: Accepts career changers, accepts no experience, accepts cross-industry experience, requires vertical industry experience, domestic clients, overseas clients, etc.

Automation Principle: AI identifies → user confirms → execute. For external communication, fully automatic sending by default is not recommended, to reduce the risk of mis-sent messages and mismatched expression.

09 MVP & Feature Prioritization

Priority	Feature	Rationale
P0	Applied / duplicate company badge	High frequency, directly reduces redundant work
P0	Custom application statuses	Solves daily management pain point
P0	Personal application funnel	Establishes the data foundation
P1	Industry / position / company dimension analysis	Helps users determine market positioning
P1	HR frequent feedback analysis	Identifies conversion obstacles
P1	AI job search diagnosis	Turns data into actionable recommendations
P2	Saved replies / batch resumes	Improves efficiency
P2	Fine position filtering	Reduces ineffective browsing

Why This Order?

P0 features prioritize the basic management problems users encounter every day, while simultaneously building the data structures needed for subsequent analysis. P1 features establish differentiated value, moving the platform from "managing applications" toward "understanding market feedback." P2 features are efficiency enhancements that can be gradually added once the core loop is stable.

10 The Complete Product Loop

The end result is a continuously learning personal job search system:

Step 1

Position Information

Job listings, company profiles, HR profiles



Step 2

User Applications & Communication

Browsing, applying, chatting, interviewing



Step 3

Behavior & Feedback Data Generated

Application records, chat logs, outcomes



Step 4

Data Analysis + AI Recognition

Funnel analysis, pattern detection, feedback tagging



Step 5

Market Positioning & Actionable Advice

Insights, recommendations, strategy guidance



Step 6

User Refines Application Strategy

Adjusting targets, resume, and approach



Step 7

New Results Re-enter the Data System

Continuous learning and improvement

This forms a closed loop: Position Information → User Behavior → HR Feedback → Data Analysis → AI Diagnosis → Strategy Adjustment → Re-application.

11 Product Value

From Recruitment Matchmaking to Career Decision-Making

Layer 1 — Recruitment Matchmaking

Helping users find positions, find companies, find HR.

Layer 2 — Application Management

Helping users manage applications, track progress, avoid duplicates, and improve communication efficiency.

Layer 3 — Market Feedback

Telling users which industries, positions, companies, and requirements tend to respond positively to them.

Layer 4 — Career Decision

Helping users understand their market positioning and adjust their job search direction through continuous feedback.

Core Product Insight

The truly valuable data on a recruitment platform is not just "how many positions I've seen," but "how the market responds to me."

Therefore, Boss Zhipin's job seeker side can evolve from a "job-finding tool" into a "personal career decision and market feedback platform."

12 Personal Product Reflections

The starting point of this case was not to simulate a fictional requirement, but to observe problems from real user behavior: when users continuously use a product and accumulate a large amount of behavioral data, can the product in turn help users understand themselves?

I believe this is also a worthwhile difference to explore between AI products and traditional feature products: rather than simply adding an AI entry point, let AI truly understand what has happened to the user in the past and help them decide what to do next.

If a recruitment platform can connect users' positions, applications, communications, and outcomes, it becomes more than a "job database" — it can become a user's long-term career feedback system.

Keywords

User Needs Analysis · User Journey · Product Feature Design · Data Analysis · User Experience · AI Product Thinking · Business Analysis · Career Decision-Making